

American Psycho

„American Psycho“ is a book by Bret Easton Ellis from 1991. It tells the story of a successful New York investment banker Patrick Bateman whose life is affected by modern materialism and conformity making it shallow and mostly revolving around money and image. This makes everyone seem dehumanized to him; combine that with his existential emptiness and you have the perfect formula to go insane, and that's exactly what happens here.

“American Psycho” is one of few contemporary books that actually taps into the psyche of men. It shows us the consequences of masking our personalities, opinions, true selves and most importantly the absurdity of the post modern era. Throughout the novel repeatedly we can see Patrick's inner psychopathic thoughts surface immersing us into his sick and twisted mind.

In my opinion it's a great book touching the problem of the world we live in, where everyone performs and acts the same making everything around us feel fake and inauthentic. This bubble of fakeness and semblances can sometimes push us into insanity which is pictured in this book. Ultimately, Ellis presents madness not as an exception, but as a logical outcome of a society built on appearances.